

Twenty to One

OpenAI's whiplash week 🤖, Washington's AI task force 🏛️, the robot stat that isn't 🤖 — Plus: the 2% number that says AI's payoff is still unproven

9:30 AM

Twenty *to* One TECH

We read the tech newsletters. You read this.

7 newsletters · 13 issues → 1 · 7-min read · 37 ads removed

READ FOR THIS ISSUE · each story shows which of these covered it

- ☒ Superhuman AI
- ☒ The Neuron
- ☒ Bytes
- ☒ DevOps'ish
- ☒ Changelog Nightly
- ☒ Semafor
- ☒ Exponential View

NUMBER OF THE DAY

Share of S&P 500 companies that disclose an AI metric they track over time, even though nearly 30% say AI has had a "quantifiable impact." The spending is easy to count. The payoff isn't, yet.

The Neuron, citing a16z

- 1 OpenAI shipped a new agent, then spent the week dealing with exits, lawyers and politics.
- 2 Washington's new AI task force: who actually polices the labs?
- 3 A viral robot stat, and the much smaller number underneath it.

THE BIG ONE 4 of 7 newsletters 2-MIN READ

OpenAI's whiplash week: a new agent out front, turmoil behind it

SOURCES DIFFER

SO WHAT OpenAI is shipping at full speed toward an IPO while its own staff, its lawyers and its politics pull the other way. How it handles that will shape how it is regulated.

At DevDay, OpenAI launched Dots, an AI agent with its own cloud computer and browser, plus a Decisions API and a new model, GPT-6.1 Sol. Bytes says every one copies a competitor's product. Exponential View calls Dots a rival to Grok Bot, and notes SpaceXAI owns dot.com, which redirects to the Grok Bot download page.

BEHIND THE LAUNCH	
LAUNCHED	Dots, the Decisions API and GPT-6.1 Sol, all announced at DevDay.
REPORTED	Legal exposure is mounting after OpenAI alerted more than 100 organizations to unauthorized activity linked to its models. Its president also pulled the second half of a \$50 million pledge to an anti-regulation super PAC after staff pushback.
DISPUTED	Why people are leaving. OpenAI says three safety researchers mishandled sensitive information. Semafor says staff are using their leverage over unregulated AI; another employee quit publicly Saturday, writing he had "decided that the current path is unacceptable."

OpenAI also reportedly hired former White House cyber official Thomas Lind to lead cyber and strategic risk policy. The three researchers and Saturday's resignation may be different people.

FROM Semafor · The Neuron · Bytes · Exponential View

THE SPLIT 2 of 7 newsletters 2-MIN READ

Washington has a new AI task force. Who actually polices the labs?

SO WHAT The White House is organising around AI but leaving risk to the companies. The FTC is moving the other way, with subpoena-like demands due within weeks.

On Sunday the White House announced a "Super Intelligence Force" led by the director of national intelligence and the FTC chairman, with the vice president, defense and Treasury secretaries and former AI czar David Sacks. It has 120 days to report on AI's risks and opportunities. It follows last week's executive safety pact, which Semafor calls morally binding and The Neuron calls voluntary.

SIDE A Let the companies handle it

Officials say the task force will defer to firms on managing risk.

— Semafor

Nvidia's Jensen Huang frames safety as an engineering problem, not a legal one, and he and Mark Zuckerberg argue the onus is on companies. — Semafor

SIDE B Use the laws on the books

The FTC's probe into OpenAI, Anthropic and METR is ramping up: an FTC official confirmed subpoena-like demands are expected within weeks. — Semafor

Former FTC chair Lina Khan says regulators should rely on existing law, not on tech CEOs' manifestos and blog posts. — Semafor

Two caveats from Semafor itself: past FTC tech cases mostly ended in settlements, so this one may not yield much, and companies may soon face a Democrat-led Congress. Semafor's headline also called the news a new AI czar; the details describe a task force.

FROM Semafor · The Neuron

HYPE CHECK 1 of 7 newsletters 1-MIN READ

"Robots can do 74% of physical tasks." Look closer. SELF-REPORTED

That was Superhuman AI's headline on a new Anthropic report about robots and jobs. The report's actual numbers are smaller, and the most important one is tiny.

THE FINE PRINT	
IN THE REPORT	Existing robots could handle work representing 34% of US working hours. Driving and warehouse jobs are most exposed; nursing and repair the least.
THE CATCH	Robots are cheaper than people for just 0.3% of tasks today, and that share may take 40 years to reach 10%.
UNEXPLAINED	The 74% in the headline appears nowhere in the newsletter's text.

FROM Superhuman AI

EVERYTHING ELSE THAT MATTERED 2 of 7 newsletters SOURCES DIFFER

Is the AI money real? Both camps got new numbers

Bain says AI's compute demand will require \$6 trillion a year in revenue by 2031, about \$4.2 trillion of it from products that don't exist yet. The five biggest spenders put \$416 billion into capital investment in 2025 (all capex, not just AI); analysts expect \$777 billion this year and \$1.1 trillion in 2027. a16z argues cheaper AI expands usage, while one asset manager's chief investment officer expects a correction: "I think it will come."

The Neuron · Semafor · 1 min

4 of 7 newsletters

Personal agents arrive, and they may come for your bank

Meta expanded Muse, including a small-business version and a Tamagotchi-like Muse Charm device; Manus shipped 2.0; OpenAI launched Dots. Apollo's Torsten Slok warns of an "agentic bank run": if agents routinely sweep idle cash into higher-paying accounts, banks' funding costs rise.

The Neuron · Superhuman AI · Exponential View · Bytes · 1 min · [Exponential View #604](#)

2 of 7 newsletters

Starship finally reaches orbit, then cuts the trip short

Flight 14 was Starship's first to reach orbit, deploying 26 Starlink V3 satellites, but it landed after about 90 minutes instead of a planned 10 hours. NASA is counting on Starship to land astronauts on the Moon, where the US wants a nuclear reactor by 2030 and Russia and China are aiming for 2036.

Superhuman AI · Semafor · 1 min

2 of 7 newsletters SELF-REPORTED

Amazon answers the data-center backlash

Amazon will publish its energy and water use every year and spend more than \$1 billion over five years on community college, trades training and home efficiency near its sites. AWS CEO Matt Garman also posted roughly 3,000 words rebutting what he called myths.

Semafor · The Neuron · 1 min

2 of 7 newsletters

Can AI be conscious? Three answers in one weekend

A Google DeepMind paper proposes a five-level test; Exponential View's team scored today's AI between 0.003 and 0.083 out of 1. Anthropic has been consulting theologians on the question. Pope Leo XIV says algorithms lack "the spark of humanity."

Exponential View · The Neuron · 1 min · [Exponential View weekend reads](#)

1 of 7 newsletters SELF-REPORTED

DoorDash gets cleared to run its own drone airline

An FAA Part 135 certificate lets DoorDash operate its own fleet, DoorDash Air, mainly for orders 3 to 5 miles away. DoorDash says drone deliveries averaged 25 minutes in 2025.

Superhuman AI · 1 min

TRY THIS TODAY

When an AI explanation loses you, change the format, not the question

Andrej Karpathy's tricks for getting a better explanation: ask for a diagram first, ask for the answer "in HTML," or ask for it in ASD-STE100, the simplified English written for aerospace maintenance manuals. A looser version is to go "80% of the way" to that standard.

Explain [topic] about 80% of the way to ASD-STE100 Simplified Technical English. Start with a diagram, then the explanation.

Via The Neuron. Not sponsored, and nothing in this issue is.

FOR BUILDERS

- RELEASE

Pi 1.0. The minimalist TypeScript agent harness adds Pi Durable (cloud agents that survive crashes, still experimental per The Neuron), Codemod scripts in a QuickJS sandbox, and virtual models that route queries.
Bytes · The Neuron
- CASE STUDY

Netflix lets a robot shrink its containers, and shares the failure. A 50% memory cut passed every check, ran fine for two weeks, then a traffic shift pushed retries past 60%. Cuts are now capped at 15% per step, with automatic reverts. [Netflix TechBlog](#)
DevOps'ish
- CASE STUDY

Netlify drops V8 isolates for Firecracker microVMs. SELF-REPORTED Median warm invocations fell from 25–40 ms to about 5–6 ms. [Netlify blog](#)
DevOps'ish
- DEBATE

Should Terraform run your developer platform? codecentric says no, since it has no runtime, and reaches for Kubernetes and Crossplane. Pinterest kept Terraform and fenced it in across hundreds of workspaces. [Pinterest's design](#)
DevOps'ish
- RELEASE

Microsoft's WSLC is generally available. Linux containers on Windows, open source in the microsoft/wsl repo. Docker Desktop has a first-party competitor. [Phoronix](#)
DevOps'ish
- WEB

Preact 11, Effect 4.0, MSW v3. Preact 11 lands after six-plus years with a new hydration system. Effect 4.0 is pitched as 5x smaller and 6.4x faster. MSW v3 is now pure ESM.
Bytes
- REPOS

sofka, kor, iam-policy-autopilot. A Rust Kubernetes TUI (1,600 stars in three months); a Go tool that finds unused Kubernetes resources; and an AWS Labs CLI and MCP server that writes baseline IAM policies from the SDK calls in your code. [sofka on GitHub](#)
DevOps'ish
- TRENDING

moli: a headless browser for AI agents, in Rust. 6,113 stars by Saturday, on Changelog Nightly's hottest-repos list two nights running. [Changelog Nightly](#)
Changelog Nightly

CAREER SIGNAL

Platform engineers rarely get a product manager, so their work only exists if they invent it. One essay suggests looking at postmortems, the cloud bill and your own toil, with the warning that your toil isn't your users'. Another argues the engineers thriving with AI agents are the ones willing to set their experience aside long enough to see a problem fresh.

FROM DevOps'ish · Inventing work · First-principles thinking

THREE THINGS TO BRING UP AT DINNER

- Singapore's government runs its own dating service, matching people with the Gale-Shapley algorithm. [Exponential View](#)
- On a suggestion from Arnold Schwarzenegger, Figure retired its F.02 humanoids by training them to leap into a 75-ton vat of molten steel at a Finnish foundry. [Superhuman AI](#)
- Researchers found gentoo penguins are actually four species, including the first new penguin species named in over 100 years. [Superhuman AI](#)

Superhuman AI

Superhuman AI

How was today's issue?

- Loved it
- It was fine
- Not for me

HOW THIS ISSUE WAS MADE

We read 13 issues from 7 newsletters (Friday 9:30 a.m. ET, Oct. 2, to early Monday, Oct. 5), merged the stories they share, stripped 37 sponsored and promotional blocks, and credited every fact to the newsletter that reported it. This sample was built before Monday's morning newsletters (TLDR and others) arrived. The reporting is theirs, so follow the links.

Superhuman AI · The Neuron · Bytes · DevOps'ish · Changelog Nightly · Semafor · Exponential View

Twenty *to* One

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Sample issue · built from real newsletter issues received Oct. 2–5, 2026. {{postal_address}}